

Application For Paul Murphy

Application Type

Transfer Fall 2026

Personal Information

Name: Paul (Paul) Murphy

Pronoun(s): He/Him/His

Are you a twin, triplet, etc.: No

Birth date: 05/28/2007

Contact Information

Citizenship/Residency

Are you a U.S. citizen? Yes

State in which you claim legal residence: AR

Have you lived in this state your entire life? Yes

Are you currently living outside of the U.S.? No

Do you believe you are eligible for residency tuition? No Answer

Military Connection

Do you have any military experience? No

Service start date: 1/1/0001

Actual or Projected Service end date: 1/1/0001

Mailing Address

Street line 1: 2250 N Sheffield Ave Ste 317

Street line 2:

Street line 3:

Nation: No Answer

City: Chicago

State: IL

Zip/postal code: 60614-3673

Permanent Address

Street line 1: 1135 Westfield Dr

Street line 2:

Street line 3:

Nation: No Answer

City: Conway

State: AR

Zip/postal code: 72034-7560

Primary Phone Number

Phone number: 501 3168396

Type of phone: Home

Personal Email Address

luappanda@gmail.com

Family Information

What is the primary language spoken in your home? English

Additional Languages: No Answer

Parent/Guardian Information

None Given

Education

High Schools

Arkansas Sch Math and Sciences

School type: US (Domestic)

City: Hot Springs

State/province: AR

Country: US

Start date: 8/2022

End date: 5/2025

Does this school use block scheduling? No Answer

Is this the school from which you plan to graduate? Yes

Graduation Date

When will you or did you graduate from high school? 5/1/2025

Colleges

Depaul Univ

City: Chicago
State/province: IL
Country: US
Start date: 9/2025
End date: 6/2026
Highest degree earned: No Answer
Degree date: No Answer

Univ of Arkansas at Fort Smith

City: Fort Smith
State/province: AR
Country: US
Start date: 8/2022
End date: 5/2025
Highest degree earned: No Answer
Degree date: No Answer

Courses

Are you currently taking college courses or will you be taking college courses prior to your intended enrollment at our campus? Yes

FOUNDATIONS OF PROGRAMMING I

Subject: CS

Course number: 1014

Term: Spring

Hours: 4.00

Institution: Univ of Arkansas at Fort Smith

Schedule system: Semester

FOUNDATIONS OF PROGRAMMING II

Subject: CS

Term: Winter

Course number: 1024

Hours: 4.00

Institution: Univ of Arkansas at Fort Smith

Schedule system: Semester

COMPOSITION I

Subject: ENGL

Term: Winter

Course number: 1203

Hours: 3.00

Institution: Univ of Arkansas at Fort Smith

Schedule system: Semester

COMPOSITION II

Subject: ENGL

Term: Spring

Course number: 1213

Hours: 3.00

Institution: Univ of Arkansas at Fort Smith

Schedule system: Semester

INTRODUCTION TO GLOBAL LITERATURE

Subject: ENGL

Term: Winter

Course number: 2013

Hours: 3.00

Institution: Univ of Arkansas at Fort Smith

Schedule system: Semester

CIVILIZATIONS OF THE WORLD SINCE 1500

Subject: HIST

Term: Winter

Course number: 1133

Hours: 3.00

Institution: Univ of Arkansas at Fort Smith

Schedule system: Semester

UNITED STATES HISTORY II

Subject: HIST

Term: Spring

Course number: 2763

Hours: 3.00

Institution: Univ of Arkansas at Fort Smith

Schedule system: Semester

COLLEGE ALGEBRA

Subject: MATH

Term: Spring

Course number: 1403

Hours: 3.00

Institution: Univ of Arkansas at Fort Smith

Schedule system: Semester

PLANE TRIGONOMETRY

Subject: MATH

Term: Winter

Course number: 1453

Hours: 3.00

Institution: Univ of Arkansas at Fort Smith

Schedule system: Semester

CALCULUS I

Subject: MATH

Term: Spring

Course number: 2804

Hours: 4.00

Institution: Univ of Arkansas at Fort Smith

Schedule system: Semester

CALCULUS II

Subject: MATH

Term: Winter

Course number: 2854

Hours: 4.00

Institution: Univ of Arkansas at Fort Smith

Schedule system: Semester

UNIVERSITY PHYSICS I

Subject: PHYS

Term: Winter

Course number: 2903

Hours: 3.00

Institution: Univ of Arkansas at Fort Smith

Schedule system: Semester

UNIVERSITY PHYSICS I LABORATORY

Subject: PHYS

Term: Winter

Course number: 2911

Hours: 1.00

Institution: Univ of Arkansas at Fort Smith

Schedule system: Semester

INTRODUCTION TO SPEECH COMMUNICATION

Subject: SPCH

Term: Spring

Course number: 1203

Hours: 3.00

Institution: Univ of Arkansas at Fort Smith

Schedule system: Semester

HONORS DISCOVER CHICAGO

Subject: HON

Term: Winter

Course number: 110

Hours: 4.00

Institution: Depaul Univ

Schedule system: Quarter

INTERMEDIATE JAPANESE I

Subject: JPN

Term: Winter

Course number: 104

Hours: 4.00

Institution: Depaul Univ

Schedule system: Quarter

DISCRETE MATHEMATICS I

Subject: MAT

Term: Winter

Course number: 140

Hours: 4.00

Institution: Depaul Univ

Schedule system: Quarter

DATA STRUCTURES I

Subject: CSC

Course number: 300

Institution: Depaul Univ

Term: Winter

Hours: 4.00

Schedule system: Quarter

RELG WORLDVIEW/ETHIC PERSPCTV

Subject: HON

Course number: 104

Institution: Depaul Univ

Term: Winter

Hours: 4.00

Schedule system: Quarter

INTERMEDIATE JAPANESE II

Subject: JPN

Course number: 105

Institution: Depaul Univ

Term: Winter

Hours: 4.00

Schedule system: Quarter

DISCRETE MATHEMATICS II

Subject: MAT

Course number: 141

Institution: Depaul Univ

Term: Winter

Hours: 4.00

Schedule system: Quarter

Repeated Courses

Have you ever repeated a course? No

Other Academic Information

Ap/IB Exams

Have you ever taken Advanced Placement (AP) or International Baccaluareate (IB) exams? No

GCE/A-Level examss

Have you ever taken GCE/A-Level exams? No

Academic Challenges

All college work must be reported on your application, including dual credit. If there is a gap between your high school and college enrollment or any break in your college education, please use this space to briefly explain the circumstances.

Have you faced any challenges throughout your academic career that you feel we should be aware of while reviewing your application? No

If you are unable to meet the requirements for your intended program of study, please provide an explanation:

No Answer

Major

Major selection: Civil Engineering

Second-choice major selection: No Answer

Pre-Professional Program: No Answer

Writing

Explain your interest in the major you selected. Describe how you have recently developed this interest, inside and/or outside of the classroom, and how this major relates to your professional goals. (300-400 words)

My interest in Civil Engineering started when I went on a study abroad delegation to Japan, and I was taken back by the efficiency and effectiveness of Japanese trains. Moreover, the way this system interacted with other well-designed Japanese infrastructure. For example, the way Japanese zoning laws allow buildup around train stations to make "mini-cities," something we have not yet replicated here in the US.

Inspired by this, I led a team researching the feasibility of a proposed metro system for the Central Arkansas metro area. We used genetic algorithms in this project to generate optimal metro station placements -- a kind of blend between computer science and civil. My team then quantified and presented this research at my high school and to a local transportation authority.

In the meantime, I have been working with a friend to build a wireless mouse from the ground up. My main focus has been designing and prototyping a custom PCB using tools like KiCad. While this project is electrical in nature, it has deepened my understanding of constraints, iterative design, and reliability. I believe that there is a clear crossover here to civil and transportation infrastructure, where safety margins and real-world limitations are also essential. These projects have ignited an interest in me for engineering; I can't wait to continue learning and building more things!

My academic experiences have also contributed to my interest in engineering. More specifically, I took University Physics I (dual enrollment through UAFS) senior year in high school, and this solidified to me that I am most engaged when applying math and physics to real-world, large-scale issues. As I've explored computer science classes and the computer science job market, I've realized that I'm more engaged and aligned with engineering solutions in a built environment.

At UIUC, I hope to take advantage of the transportation systems focus in the Department of Civil and Environmental Engineering, including the Illinois Center for Transportation and the SMART Infrastructure research initiative. I wish to study traffic flow theory, transportation planning, and infrastructure resilience, all while incorporating computational methods into civil applications. To tie it up, I hope to design transportation systems to improve connectivity and reflect the likes of the Tokyo metro network, the Japanese Shinkansen, and the Seoul metro network.

Activities

Involvement

Work at DePaul University

Position: Technical Deployment Assistant

Years: Fresh

Time commitment: 40

Time commitment high: 10

Time commitment low: 20

Description: Provide support for software/hardware issues for 10+ staff/faculty, configure and image computers for 50+ faculty/staff, document and report equipment inventory weekly, manage tickets in ServiceNow, helped training 1 new team member

Intramural Volleyball at DePaul University

Position: Team captain

Years: Fresh

Time commitment: 15

Time commitment high: 5

Time commitment low: 5

Description: Led a team of 10, competed in games weekly, organized games and team practice, built leadership skills

NSLI-Y Study Abroad Scholarship from Department of State

Position: Delegate

Years: Senior

Time commitment: 6

Time commitment high: 168

Time commitment low: 168

Description: Studied abroad for 6 weeks, made connections with locals and peers, learned language and diplomacy skills

Work service at ASMSA

Position: Volunteer

Years: Sophomore, Junior, Senior

Time commitment: 36

Time commitment high: 2

Time commitment low: 2

Description: Helped in school cafeteria, school maintenance, professors, residential staff for 100+ hours

Student Leader at ASMSA

Position: Community Leader

Years: Senior

Time commitment: 36

Time commitment high: 5

Time commitment low: 5

Description: Volunteered as an RA-like mentor for 30+ students at my residential high school, organized 13+ events, communicated with administration, built social skills, resolved multiple conflicts

Work at St. Lukes Episcopal Church

Position: Singer and web developer

Years: Senior

Time commitment: 30

Time commitment high: 3

Time commitment low: 3

Description: Sung at a local church weekly, made connections in the local community, implemented multiple website improvements

Honors and Distinctions

Please share up to five honors, awards, distinctions, or unique experiences.

Hot Springs Sister City Delegate to Japan

Level: District

When Achieved: Junior

Arkansas Computer Science Student of Distinction

Level: Regional/State

When Achieved: Senior

Burger King Scholars Program recipient

Level: National

When Achieved: Senior

35 on ACT

Level: High School/Local

When Achieved: Senior

Disciplinary History

Academic Leave

Have you ever had to leave an educational institution due to academic reasons? No

Disciplinary Action

Have you ever been subject to disciplinary action from an educational institution? No

Payment Method

Credit Card

Need help? Email admissions@illinois.edu (<mailto:admissions@illinois.edu>) or call 217-333-0302.

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